

Taxing Times

The Sixth Pay Commission raised salaries of government employees by substantial amounts ("The Industry Push", June 22). On the same lines, the income tax exemption limit should be raised to Rs 3 lakh for all assesses. Time limit to issue refunds, assessment orders and completion of all cases must be reduced from one year to six months or so.

MAHESH KAPASI,
via www.indiatoday.in

Flight of Fancy

Manmohan Singh knows that it is not possible to soar with eagles when one is obliged to work with turkeys, but he also understands that in a coalition set-up, you can't pin your aspirations on birds of your choice ("M-77 and the Art of Jugglery", June 15). The abiding solution to this enigma is to ensure result-orientation and quality. Ministers may come and go but as long as the bureaucratic steel frame is allowed autonomy, and is held accountable, results will follow.

BISHAN SAHAI,
via www.indiatoday.in

Ground Zero

Racial or opportunistic, or a mix of both, the attacks on Indian students in Australia are worrying for everyone concerned ("The Fear Factor", June 15). The attacks reflect the inefficiency, inadequacy and

unwillingness on the part of the Australian authorities to provide a congenial atmosphere to Indian students, who are contributing hugely to their economy. Each case deserves lawful investigation for racial slurs and perhaps for vilification. As Indians find these attacks difficult to swallow, it is hoped that the authorities will make Australia more student-friendly.

DR SANJIV GUPTA,
Perth, Australia

KRISHNA MURARI KUSHAN



“The Upper House should be a house of talent rather than a dumping ground for leaders like Ram Vilas Paswan who seek to gain entry there as an employment opportunity.”

SUBHASH CHANDRA AGRAWAL, Delhi

Going Green

Corporate India's growing awareness about keeping carbon emission levels low is a positive sign ("Plug and Profit", June 15). It also presents a lucrative business opportunity for companies that can go in for climate-friendly technology and carbon credit manufacturing. Even the smaller

companies should also adopt this technology for the good of the country and world at large.

V.K. TANGRI, Dehradun

Young House

With more youngsters and women visible in the corridors of power, the Lok Sabha indubitably looks more powered and geared-up ("The New Face of Parliament," June 1). But the older generation at the helm of affairs has to make way and give

the young brigade more opportunities to prove themselves in the actual role of governance. The active participation of young MPs in the Government would emanate the true essence of the people's mandate. Let's give young India a chance to change.

K. CHIDANAND KUMAR,
Bangalore

30
YEARS
AGO IN
INDIA
TODAY

AUGUST 16-31, 1979

Yes, to Mid-Term Poll

August 20 is the D-day for the embryonic Charan Singh government. On that day, exactly 23 days after the new government was sworn in, India's political wheel of fortune will take another bizarre turn. For the first time in the country's history, a government is seeking a vote of confidence in the Lok Sabha rather than having one moved against it.

Whichever way the dice falls for Charan Singh, protracted political instability has come to stay. An era of uncertainty is upon the nation. The political scene today is like a sea of sharks feeding upon each other—a savage mating of power-hungry carnivores. The unlikely alliances are being forged almost everyday in the wildly-shifting political spectrum. And, in the bargain, political morality has been thrown to the winds. Ideologies have been sacrificed on the bloody altar of power. Mingling with the pall of despondency that has settled over the capital is the putrid stench of greed and corruption.



CHARAN SINGH

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